

Outlook

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Are failed ATM attempts forming an attack sequence? - 2025 control review

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

Cyber wants to know whether repeated PIN failures, balance enquiries and cash attempts form recognisable sequences before a card is blocked. The discussion is currently being driven by anecdotes, and the teams involved are describing the same customers differently.

Could the answer be that normal forgotten-PIN behaviour dominates? Or are we actually seeing that a balance enquiry followed by rapid withdrawals marks higher risk? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that specific terminals see repeated card testing.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use December 2025 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The practical decision is which sequences should become monitoring rules and which would create unacceptable false positives. Please send a working Excel file with the exception population and clear columns; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories. There is no CCTV, device fingerprint or complete card-network feed, so classify behavioural patterns rather than confirmed attacks.

Regards